Social Issues: Poverty, Employment, Rights, Displacement, Sustainability and Migration

Paper III • Unit I • Topic 3 • All 16 official social-issues clauses • In-depth explanations, Telangana analysis, eight professional mains answers, summary and quick revision

EXPANDED DRAFT — NOT ACADEMICALLY APPROVED

Exam integrity: All mains answers and MCQs in this chapter are original practice. No question is claimed as an officially authenticated TGPSC previous-year question. Refer to the current commission notification and operative legislation where a formal decision depends on exact wording.

SECTION 01 / PAPER III

Official syllabus and detailed index

Official syllabus and chapter map

TGPSC Group-I, Notification 02/2024, Annexure II, Paper III, Unit I, Topic 3.

> Social Issues: Poverty; Unemployment, Child Labour, Violence against Women; Regionalism; Communalism and Secularism; Corruption; Caste Conflicts, Problems of Agricultural Labour; Urbanization; Development and Displacement; Environmental Degradation; Sustainable Development; Population Explosion; Agrarian Distress; Migration.

Official clause	What a serious answer must cover	Detailed notes
Poverty	Monetary vs multidimensional; chronic vs transient; deprivation; MPI measurement; Telangana contrasts	Section 2
Unemployment	PLFS usual/CWS, LFPR/WPR/UR; youth, women, job quality, skill matching	Section 3
Child labour	2016 amendment; 6–14 education; economic drivers; migration, family-work exceptions	Section 4
Violence against women	Physical/economic/psychological harms; PWDVA 2005; POSH 2013; institutions	Section 5
Regionalism	Constitutional demands vs exclusion; 1956, 1969, 2014 Telangana milestones	Section 6
Communalism and secularism	Identity politics; Articles 14–16, 25–30; rights and accountability	Section 7
Corruption	Petty/grand/state capture; PCA 1988/2018; institutional design	Section 8
Caste conflicts	Graded inequality; dominant caste; atrocity law; land and local power	Section 9
Agricultural labour	Seasonal wages, landlessness, MGNREGA, gender, worker protection	Section 10
Urbanisation	Urban share vs population growth; primacy, informal housing, Musi	Section 11
Development and displacement	Physical/economic displacement; Cernea; 2013 land acquisition law	Section 12
Environmental degradation	Water, air, ecology, exposures, legal responsibilities and justice	Section 13
Sustainable development	Brundtland, SDGs, strong/weak sustainability, trade-offs	Section 14
Population explosion	TFR, demographic transition, momentum, ageing, rights	Section 15
Agrarian distress	Crop vs price risk, net margins, debt, tenant farmers, Telangana	Section 16

Official clause	What a serious answer must cover	Detailed notes
Migration	Circular vs permanent, portability, housing, wage protections	Section 17

Exam pattern: The official Paper III pattern gives approximately 200 words per 10-mark question. The student chapter contains original ~200–250-word models rather than unverified official past questions.

SECTION 02 / PAPER III

Topic summary

Topic summary — the entire Social Issues syllabus in one review

Social problems arise from interactions among **unequal resources, social power, institutions, the environment and household coping strategies**. A good answer first locates a mechanism, not a moral failing, and then proposes an intervention whose outcome can be measured.

1. **Poverty:** distinguish money poverty, multidimensional deprivation, persistent poverty and temporary shock-related poverty. Specify reference year before citing the MPI.
2. **Unemployment:** UR uses the labour force as denominator; PLFS usual status and current weekly status differ. Underemployment and informal job quality require separate measures.
3. **Child labour:** child employment rules changed in 2016; adolescent hazardous work and the statutory family-work exceptions require exact legal treatment. School retention and adult wages are connected.
4. **Violence against women:** analyse unequal power, under-reporting, protection and workplace mechanisms. PWDVA 2005 and POSH 2013 have different purposes.
5. **Regionalism:** Telangana's 1956 safeguards, 1969 agitation and 2014 state formation demonstrate democratic territorial demands; new borders do not automatically correct intra-state inequality.
6. **Communalism/secularism:** constitutional secularism protects freedom of conscience, equality and minority cultural rights; communal mobilisation turns identity into antagonistic politics.
7. **Corruption:** separate petty bribery, grand corruption and capture; evaluate procurement transparency, service standards and complaint outcomes.
8. **Caste conflicts:** rights assertion, land, wages, local status and electoral power may intersect; Ambedkar and Srinivas supply different analytical lenses.
9. **Agricultural labour:** landlessness, seasonality, wage bargaining, women's labour, heat risks and rural nonfarm options matter independently of crop yields.
10. **Urbanisation:** Hyderabad's metropolitan primacy offers agglomeration advantages but creates inequality in housing, public transit, ecology and catchment management.
11. **Displacement:** compensation for titled land is not comprehensive rehabilitation of livelihood, common-resource rights and social networks.
12. **Environmental degradation:** pollution and climate exposures are unequal; governance must assess neighbourhood-level harms and enforcement.
13. **Sustainable development:** present welfare must be compatible with the capabilities of future generations; ecological and social trade-offs cannot be wished away.

14. **Population:** declining TFR can coexist with continuing growth through demographic momentum; the demographic dividend needs productive jobs and women's participation.
15. **Agrarian distress:** yields, prices, inputs, debt, tenancy and market power jointly shape net income; tenants and workers need separate attention.
16. **Migration:** circular and permanent movement require different policy designs; fair mobility needs portable services, wages and safe accommodation.

Telangana integrated chain: unpredictable dryland earnings → household debt → seasonal migration to Hyderabad → informal housing/school discontinuity → vulnerability. Reverse the chain with reliable local work, education portability, urban rental services and accessible grievance redressal.

One-line conclusion: Inclusive social development is measured by **capabilities, dignity, security, participation and resilience**, not the number of schemes announced.

SECTION 03 / PAPER III

Quick revision and answer technique

Quick revision — short, medium and high-intensity

90-second checklist

- **Poverty:** monetary / relative / MPI / chronic / transient. NITI 2022–23 MPI 11.28% is an *estimate*, not a 2026 survey.
- **Jobs:** UR = unemployed / labour force; LFPR = labour force / population; WPR = employed / population. Do not compare usual-status UR to monthly CWS without caveat.
- **Child labour:** amended law 2016; generally under-14 work prohibited with limited exceptions; ages 14–18 hazardous work prohibited; RTE 6–14.
- **Women:** PWDVA 2005 covers domestic protection; POSH 2013 workplace redressal; recorded offences ≠ prevalence.
- **Regionalism:** Gentlemen's Agreement 1956 → 1969 movement → Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act 2014 → Telangana formed 2 June 2014.
- **Communalism:** organised religious antagonism ≠ religious identity; Articles 14, 15, 16, 25–30.
- **Corruption:** PCA 1988 (amended 2018), Lokpal Act 2013; procurement audit and citizen appeal.
- **Caste:** Ambedkar graded inequality; Srinivas dominant caste; Article 17, PCR 1955, PoA 1989.
- **Agricultural labour:** seasonal days, real wages, land, unpaid care; MGNREGA = household 100-day entitlement under the 2005 law.
- **City:** urban growth ≠ urbanisation; GHMC municipal vs HMDA metro planning; Musi is catchment issue.
- **Displacement:** physical vs economic; Cernea eight impoverishment risks; 2013 LARR law where applicable.
- **Environment:** exposure ≠ emission; environmental justice means unequal burden recognition.
- **Sustainability:** Brundtland 1987; 17 SDGs; present gains vs long-run water/heat/ecology.
- **Population:** TFR ≠ birth rate; population momentum; demographic dividend is conditional.
- **Agrarian distress:** yield, market, cost, credit and tenancy risks; farmer ≠ farm labourer.
- **Migration:** seasonal/circular vs permanent; portability, school continuity, safe housing.

5-minute conceptual map

1. **Economic:** poverty, unemployment, agrarian distress, agricultural labour, migration.
2. **Social power:** caste conflict, violence against women, child labour, communalism, corruption.
3. **Spatial and ecological:** urbanisation, displacement, environmental degradation, sustainability.
4. **Political and demographic:** regionalism, secularism, population transition.
5. **Cross-link:** labour-market insecurity + discrimination + environmental shock → capability shortfall.

Answer-writing template (~200 words for 10 marks)

Opening (25 words): precise definition and thesis. **Mechanisms (90 words):** 3–4 non-overlapping, causally explained drivers. **Distinctive evidence (45 words):** named law/ institution, dated datum where verified, Telangana illustration. **Evaluation (25 words):** what the law or scheme cannot itself solve. **Conclusion (15 words):** measurable and rights-consistent remedy.

Mistakes to avoid

- Giving a current year without its official reference period.
- Claiming all working children or all adolescent jobs are legally identical.
- Equating any religious difference with communalism.
- Treating Telangana's 2014 formation as proof all regional inequality ended.
- Treating land compensation as full rehabilitation.
- Mixing urban population size, urban share and administrative reclassification.
- Describing migration as invariably harmful or beneficial.
- Treating a programme announcement as a confirmed achieved outcome.

SECTION 04 / PAPER III

Complete textbook-style explanations

Social Issues in India: Structures, Conflicts and Inclusive Development

Paper III | Unit I | Topic 3 | TGPSC Group-I Mains | Deep explanatory draft | 22 October 2026

1. How to study social issues: causes, institutions and consequences

A *social issue* is not simply an individual hardship. It is a persistent condition that affects a substantial group, is embedded in institutions or unequal power, and invites public deliberation or collective remedy. Poverty may be expressed through an undernourished person, yet its determinants include wages, land ownership, food prices, discrimination, public-service access and the distribution of unpaid work. Crime against women may involve an identifiable perpetrator but is also shaped by norms, reporting barriers, housing insecurity and failures of institutional response. Strong TGPSC answers therefore move beyond moral condemnation to explain **who is vulnerable, through what mechanism, and at which administrative level an intervention would work**.

Three conceptual lenses are useful. **Structural inequality** highlights unequal property, caste hierarchy, occupational segmentation and gendered authority. **Capabilities**, associated with Amartya Sen, ask what people are genuinely free to do and become, not only how much money they receive. **Social exclusion** identifies barriers that prevent people from converting legal rights into usable opportunities. These lenses are complementary: a cash transfer may reduce immediate hardship, while schools, secure tenure, safety and freedom from discrimination determine long-run capabilities. Finally, the **life-cycle and intersectional lens** shows that a migrant adolescent girl working in an informal enterprise faces overlapping age, gender, class and residential disadvantages.

For a 10-mark question, define the issue in one or two sentences; develop three or four **distinct causal mechanisms**, name the relevant constitutional or statutory instrument, provide one accurate national or Telangana example, then offer an intervention with an indicator by which it could be evaluated. A programme's name is never sufficient evidence of success. Distinguish a law's intention from its enforcement and a survey's result from a current administrative count.

2. Poverty: monetary, multidimensional, relative and intergenerational

Absolute monetary poverty measures whether command over consumption or income is below a specified threshold; the result varies with the poverty line, prices, survey method and reference year. **Relative poverty** concerns disadvantage compared with prevailing social standards; it can coexist with rising average incomes. **Multidimensional poverty** assesses deprivations in health, education and living standards, recognising that a family with a marginally higher income can still lack sanitation, schooling or health access. **Transient poverty** results from a shock such as illness or crop failure, while **chronic poverty** persists when assets, opportunities and social power remain constrained.

The National Multidimensional Poverty Index uses a weighted deprivation method informed by Alkire-Foster measurement. Official estimates and projections must be labelled correctly: NITI Aayog's January 2024 discussion paper estimated an **11.28%** multidimensional-poverty headcount for **2022–23**, rather than supplying a directly enumerated 2026 poverty census. A student should not treat the figure as the current monetary poverty rate. At the household level, debt service, medical expenses, education cost, landlessness and gendered care responsibilities cause a **poverty trap**: low earnings prevent asset accumulation, and weak assets perpetuate low productivity. Poverty can be geographically clustered where irrigation, transport, schools and health facilities are inadequate.

Telangana examples should compare rural dryland households vulnerable to monsoon-related earnings volatility with low-income renters in Hyderabad who face high housing and commuting costs despite proximity to jobs. The policy design must join reliable employment, health protection, safe housing and education. MGNREGA, under its **2005 statute**, guarantees up to **100 days of wage employment to each eligible rural household** whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work; it is not an unconditional individual entitlement for every resident. Beyond counting beneficiaries, measure timely wage payment, actual person-days, local asset durability, school attendance and the persistence of distress borrowing.

High-yield exam distinction: reduction in a national MPI estimate is important, but it neither disproves deprivation in particular communities nor measures inequality among all groups. Use the words *headcount, intensity, method, period and denominator* before quoting a percentage.

3. Unemployment and underemployment: measurement before explanation

Open unemployment concerns people seeking or available for work but not employed under a specified survey definition. **Underemployment** covers people who work fewer hours or in lower-productivity activities than desired. **Disguised unemployment** is a textbook explanation for situations in which additional family workers contribute little marginal output, but it must not be assumed for every small farm. **Educated unemployment** reflects mismatch between qualifications, expectations and accessible vacancies. **Frictional** unemployment accompanies transitions, **structural** unemployment accompanies changes in skills or industry demand, and **cyclical** unemployment accompanies demand contraction.

India's Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) offers different concepts: *usual status* (principal and subsidiary economic activity over a longer reference period) and *current weekly status* (a seven-day reference frame). Their unemployment rates **cannot be directly substituted**. LFPR means labour-force participants relative to the population; WPR measures workers relative to the population; UR measures unemployed persons relative to the **labour force**, not the total population. Rising female LFPR must be interpreted alongside job quality, unpaid household work, own-account work and hours. The MoSPI annual PLFS 2025 report and its monthly 2026 bulletins have different reference periods; use the annual series for long-run comparisons and monthly CWS for recent short-run signals.

The regional employment problem is not only lack of vacancies. Hyderabad's pharma and IT clusters demand specialised skills and networks; rural graduates may face mobility costs, language requirements and incomplete information. At the same time, informal work may offer income without written contracts, predictable wages or protection. Remedies have to distinguish **job creation** (labour-intensive enterprises, infrastructure and value chains), **matching** (apprenticeships and placement), **capability** (foundational literacy and job-specific training), and **quality** (safety, security and social insurance). A state employment programme should be assessed by retention after six or twelve months, earnings progression and female participation, not just the number trained.

Mains trap: “unemployment rate fell” is not equivalent to “all jobs improved.” The latter claim requires hours, earnings, formality, productivity and occupational distribution.

4. Child labour: a rights, schooling and household-income issue

A child's work can range from age-appropriate light household tasks to dangerous or exploitative employment. In legal analysis distinguish a **child** (under 14, subject to the applicable RTE-linked definition) from an **adolescent** (14–18). Under the Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986 as amended in **2016**, employment of children is generally prohibited, with narrowly framed statutory exceptions, while adolescents are prohibited in specified hazardous occupations and processes. The legal treatment of permitted family assistance outside school hours has attracted criticism because it can conceal commercial production. Do not write that every form of helping at home is automatically an offence, or that adolescents can freely work in mines.

Child labour is a cause and consequence of deprivation. Debt, insecure adult employment and migration may prompt reliance on a child's earnings; the lost schooling then reduces future employability and perpetuates vulnerability. Gender matters: girls' domestic work may be invisible in workplace inspections and can combine with sibling care. Employer demand persists where subcontracting, home-based production and poorly monitored supply chains make child work inexpensive and difficult to detect. The **Right to Education Act 2009** establishes free and compulsory elementary education for children aged **6–14**, but enrolment must be supported by transport, safe school facilities, learning support and language inclusion.

Policy must integrate age verification, labour inspection, rescued-child rehabilitation, bridge schooling, social protection for caregivers and worker protections for adults. In Telangana, distinguish urban workshop/home-production risks, migrant construction settlements and seasonal rural migration; do not label a specific industrial cluster or community as employing children without evidence. **Outcomes** include sustained re-enrolment, learning recovery, absence of re-entry into hazardous work and improved household resilience. Treat the 2016 amendment as a legal rule, not proof that the practice disappeared.

5. Violence against women: continuum of harm and access to justice

Violence against women includes physical, sexual, psychological and economic coercion in domestic, workplace, public and digital settings. The **Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005** recognises forms of abuse beyond physical assault and provides a civil-protection framework, whereas criminal offences are dealt with under relevant penal laws. The **Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013** requires workplace redressal mechanisms; institution-specific internal committees and local committees are not interchangeable. Crime statistics count recorded reports, not the actual prevalence of violence, and a rise in complaints can reflect changed reporting as well as incidence.

At least four mechanisms require analysis: **unequal bargaining power** in the family or workplace; **normalisation of controlling behaviour**; economic dependence and housing insecurity that make exit costly; and **institutional barriers** including stigma, unsafe reporting, weak evidence preservation and delayed proceedings. Online abuse adds non-consensual image sharing, stalking and reputational harm; any legal discussion must use the law applicable at the relevant date rather than recycling pre-2024 penal-section numbers as if unchanged.

A survivor-centred response joins emergency health care, privacy, police and judicial accountability, shelter, legal aid and livelihood support. Prevention also needs education about consent, transport design, safe workplaces and men's participation in norm change. Hyderabad's urban transit, service-work and digital-employment environments supply useful **settings**, but no safety claim should be made without data. Assess response times, compliance of workplace committees, survivor satisfaction, protection-order effectiveness and repeat victimisation; conviction rate alone is incomplete.

Examinable distinction: women’s empowerment is an ongoing distribution of voice, assets and freedom, not merely the presence of a women's welfare scheme.

6. Regionalism: representation, imbalance and constructive federalism

Regionalism is the political assertion of interests based on territory, language, historical experience, resources or identity. It may express a legitimate claim for fair allocation and self-government; it can also become exclusionary when it denies equal citizenship to newcomers. **Regional disparity** refers to unequal development, while **regional identity** expresses

attachment to a place. The two overlap but are not identical. A mains answer should analyse fiscal transfers, public employment, irrigation, education, administrative access and cultural recognition before judging a movement.

The Telangana movement offers a concrete case of demands around jobs, water, budget allocation, cultural dignity and the interpretation of safeguards within undivided Andhra Pradesh. Major historical markers include the **Gentlemen's Agreement (1956)**, the **1969 Telangana agitation**, later organisational mobilisation and the **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014**, under which Telangana came into being on **2 June 2014**. These are different moments with different legal and political status; do not present the 1956 agreement as an ordinary interstate treaty or infer that all grievances vanished at state formation.

Federalism can accommodate differences through constitutional statehood arrangements, Finance Commission transfers, local devolution, transparent recruitment, river-basin negotiations and independent impact audits. However, new state borders do not by themselves solve intra-state inequality between Hyderabad and more remote districts. **The analytical conclusion** is that democratic regionalism can widen representation, while a fair federation requires enforceable allocation rules, inclusive services and institutional channels for inter-regional negotiation.

7. Communalism and secularism: conceptual distinctions and prevention

Communalism is political reasoning that treats religious communities as unified, inherently opposed interest blocs. It is not a synonym for individual religious devotion, minority cultural rights or ordinary doctrinal difference. Differentiate everyday prejudice, organised political mobilisation, discriminatory practice and collective violence. Rumour cascades, inflammatory speech, segregation, economic competition, selective historical narratives and impunity can amplify conflict, but no single causal factor explains all episodes.

Indian secularism is often understood as constitutional **equal citizenship and principled state engagement** rather than a complete prohibition on all state interaction with religion. Articles **14, 15 and 16** support equality and nondiscrimination; **Articles 25–28** govern religious freedom and related limits; **Articles 29–30** address cultural and educational protections. The State may regulate secular aspects of religious institutions and enact social-reform measures within constitutional limits. “Equal respect” cannot be used to excuse discrimination or remove scrutiny of state decisions.

Hyderabad's long-standing Telugu, Urdu/Dakhni and other linguistic and religious interactions illustrate composite urban traditions, yet cultural coexistence does not mean conflict is impossible. Good governance requires prompt, impartial investigation of violence, protection of threatened residents, accountable policing, peace committees with credible representation, critical media literacy and nondiscriminatory public services. **Mains nuance:** reconciliation does not replace justice, and constitutional secularism protects both the freedom to practise religion and the citizen's freedom from coercion.

8. Corruption: incentives, discretion, capture and institutional design

Corruption is misuse of entrusted authority for private advantage; it includes bribery, extortion, patronage, conflict of interest, embezzlement and state capture. **Petty bribery** differs from **grand corruption** and **regulatory capture**, where rules may themselves be shaped to favour powerful actors. The Prevention of Corruption Act **1988**, amended in **2018**, provides criminal-law architecture; the **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act 2013**, transparency arrangements and audit institutions form other parts of accountability. Details about sanction for prosecution, offences and amended provisions need current statutory checking before being asserted in examination notes.

Social consequences exceed the value of an illicit payment. Corruption can distort infrastructure quality, steer public procurement away from value for money, discriminate against people lacking influence, degrade trust and convert entitlements into favour. Vulnerable citizens may suffer **regressive corruption costs** because fixed unofficial fees form a higher share of their resources. A rent-seeking explanation points to monopoly plus discretion minus accountability, but a formula is a heuristic, not an empirical law.

Prevention requires open contracting, clearly published eligibility rules, time-bound public-service standards, digitised traceable workflows with accessible offline alternatives, independent audits, whistleblower protection and effective grievance appeal. Digital processes can also create new risks: algorithmic exclusion, opaque vendor decisions and data manipulation. Telangana's service-delivery setting can be analysed through land records, licences, urban permissions and welfare distribution without presuming wrongdoing by any particular department. Measure independent complaint disposal, competitive procurement, audit closure and citizen time/cost—not only the number of digital transactions.

9. Caste conflicts: power, land, dignity and constitutional equality

Caste conflicts are not adequately explained as ancient prejudice surviving unchanged. Modern conflicts may concern land, wages, access to common resources, inter-caste marriages, local elections, education, reservation claims and assertions of equal status. Ambedkar's analysis of graded inequality illuminates hierarchy; M.N. Srinivas's concept of the **dominant caste** shows how numerical strength, land and local political power can operate independently of ritual rank. Rising education and assertion of rights can generate resistance from entrenched power, so visible conflict may accompany social change rather than only its absence.

The Constitution abolishes untouchability in **Article 17** and prohibits multiple forms of discrimination; the **Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955** and **SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989**, as amended, provide legal protections. Yet a complaint count is influenced by reporting, policing and awareness. Social inclusion must address land and tenancy, common access, educational segregation, public representation, local dispute resolution and victim protection. Use Telangana's village land, labour and panchayat contexts as settings while identifying facts for each actual case before citing it.

Mains high-value sequence: changing local power → assertion of dignity or resource claims → possible backlash → rights enforcement and dialogue → measurable institutional equality. Avoid framing caste violence as a symmetrical disagreement when the evidence points to unequal coercive power.

10. Agricultural labour: insecurity despite high rural employment

Agricultural labourers sell labour to farm operators and may be landless, marginal cultivators who also work for wages, seasonal migrants or long-term attached workers. Employment is concentrated around sowing, weeding and harvesting, creating idle periods and bargaining weakness. **Agricultural workers and farmers are overlapping but not interchangeable populations**; policies that raise crop prices may not automatically increase labourers' incomes. Wages depend on crop mix, mechanisation, rural nonfarm alternatives, labour mobility and gendered task segregation. Tenancy uncertainty and informal credit can trap workers in dependent relationships.

Distinct problems include irregular wages, absence of written contracts, unsafe chemical exposure, heat stress, inadequate child care, debt dependence, weak social protection and poor housing near work. In Telangana, cotton or paddy labour demand is seasonal and local practices vary; do not generalise one district's pattern statewide. MGNREGA's 100-day **household** statutory framework can support fallback employment and bargaining power, while road access, rural processing, skill mobility and childcare create alternatives. Labour inspection alone cannot solve dispersed informal worksites; worker collectives, wage information and grievance services matter.

The answer should examine **both labour demand and bargaining capacity**. Indicators include real daily wages, days worked per year, occupational injury, women's wage gaps, credit cost and receipt of earned wages on time. A rise in agricultural output with stagnant labour earnings signals unequal sharing of productivity gains.

11. Urbanisation: demographic change versus the urban way of life

Urbanisation means a rising proportion of people or settlements classified as urban, while **urban growth** may describe an increase in the number of urban residents even without an increasing urban share. **Urbanism** refers to social organisation and lifestyles; **peri-urbanisation** describes transformation at city edges; **metropolitan primacy** denotes concentration in one dominant city. Data comparisons must account for changing administrative boundaries and settlement reclassification. Migration, natural increase and reclassification contribute differently across towns.

Cities can improve productivity through job matching, specialisation, infrastructure and knowledge spillovers. But they also create land-price pressure, unequal access to water, informal housing and climate exposure. Hyderabad's historic core, Secunderabad, older industrial clusters and western IT corridor form an uneven urban geography. A peripheral apartment complex may

have high economic value while nearby low-income settlements lack safe walking access or reliable drainage. The Musi catchment and connected tanks show why flooding is a watershed-management challenge rather than simply a failure to widen a drain.

The policy response needs **metropolitan spatial coordination**, rental housing, secure tenure where feasible, integrated buses and Metro, safe footpaths, stormwater and wastewater management, and balanced growth in secondary towns. GHMC's municipal functions and HMDA's metropolitan planning role are different. Judge transit by **door-to-door accessibility**, not route length, and assess housing by affordability relative to income, not only units sanctioned.

12. Development and displacement: who gains and who loses?

Displacement occurs when infrastructure, mines, industries, conservation, urban renewal or disasters cause people to lose residence, land, workplaces or access to resources. **Physical displacement** means relocation of homes; **economic displacement** can occur without changing residence when livelihoods, common land, grazing or fishing access are lost. A compensation cheque for titled land does not automatically replace common-property dependence, rental networks or community institutions. Michael Cernea's impoverishment-risks model highlights **landlessness, joblessness, homelessness, marginalisation, food insecurity, morbidity, loss of common resources and social disarticulation**.

The **Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013** provides provisions for social-impact assessment, public processes and rehabilitation/resettlement in cases governed by it. Legal exceptions, state modifications and project categories must be checked separately; no one should claim every land transfer follows identical procedures. In Telangana, discuss irrigation reservoir or urban infrastructure projects as analytical settings but avoid assigning unverified displacement numbers to a named scheme.

A rights-sensitive evaluation asks: Who was counted in the affected population? Were tenant cultivators, sharecroppers, forest-resource users and informal workers visible? Did compensation reflect productive replacement costs? Were replacement housing, schools, public transport, jobs and cultural sites secured **before** displacement? Longitudinal monitoring should cover income restoration, schooling continuity, legal title, community ties and grievance disposal. Development is credible only when its beneficiaries and its social costs are both disclosed.

13. Environmental degradation: an unequal distribution of harm

Environmental degradation includes polluted air and water, soil erosion, groundwater depletion, habitat fragmentation, heat stress and loss of wetlands. Distinguish **emissions** (a flow of pollutants) from **ambient concentration** (actual exposure), and **resource scarcity** from **inequitable access**. Disadvantaged communities may face higher exposure because inexpensive housing lies near traffic, drains, industrial sites or floodplains. Exposure also varies with age, disability, occupation and indoor conditions.

India's regulatory instruments include the **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974**, **Air Act 1981**, **Environment (Protection) Act 1986**, environmental-impact assessment procedures, and constitutional reasoning based on **Article 21** and **Article 48A**. Do not imply the Right to a Healthy Environment is expressed verbatim as a standalone fundamental right in the constitutional text; judicial interpretation is important. In Telangana, link the Musi river's sewage and industrial pollution concerns, depleted urban lakes, quarry dust and coal extraction to particular monitoring needs rather than sensationalising local contamination without data.

Environmental policy must combine source control, transparent measurements, public health surveillance and fair cost allocation. Actions may involve effluent treatment, sewer connections, catchment restoration, safe mobility and livelihood transition for affected workers. **Environmental justice** asks not only how to reduce total pollution but also how costs and benefits fall on different communities. Indicators: pollutant concentration at neighbourhood scale, illness burden, groundwater quality, enforcement closure and restoration of ecological functions.

14. Sustainable development: not a slogan but a test of trade-offs

The **Brundtland Commission (1987)** defined sustainable development as meeting present needs without compromising future generations' ability to meet theirs. The **2030 Agenda and its 17 Sustainable Development Goals** connect poverty, decent work, gender equality, climate, institutions and ecological protection. Sustainability has **economic**, **social** and **environmental** dimensions, but treating them as three independent boxes misses their interactions. For example, a subsidised lift-irrigation project may raise farm income yet impose long-term electricity and aquifer costs; benefits and risks must be evaluated together.

Distinguish **weak sustainability**, which tolerates substitution of some natural capital with produced capital, from **strong sustainability**, which emphasises irreplaceable ecological thresholds and critical natural systems. Climate adaptation addresses impacts already occurring or expected; mitigation reduces causes such as greenhouse-gas emissions. A good Telangana illustration links heat action for outdoor workers, reliable urban water services, resilient transport and ecosystem protection. Distribution matters: a city may appear 'green' while shifting waste, quarrying and water burdens to nearby villages.

Use measurable outcomes such as water productivity, safe air exposure, renewable-energy output alongside total demand, worker heat-risk protections, inclusion in decision-making and lifecycle costs. **Mains line:** an environmentally efficient project that impoverishes displaced households is not socially sustainable; a welfare promise that destroys long-run water security is not environmentally sustainable.

15. Population growth, transition and demographic opportunity

The syllabus uses 'population explosion', but contemporary analysis must use the **demographic transition** rather than assume that all regions face accelerating fertility. The transition moves from high mortality and fertility toward lower mortality and fertility, with phases differing by

state, community and time. **Total fertility rate (TFR)** estimates lifetime births per woman implied by age-specific current fertility rates; it is not the crude birth rate. **Population momentum** can sustain population growth after fertility declines because the reproductive-age population remains large. Another region may instead face ageing and a rising old-age dependency burden.

Assess births, deaths, migration and age structure together. The **demographic dividend** is a potential economic benefit from a favourable working-age share, not an automatic payout: it requires education, skills, health, women's workforce participation and productive jobs. Telangana and Hyderabad face a composite picture: mobility and youth employment alongside emerging elder-care demands. Policies should expand reproductive choice, maternal care, girls' schooling and affordable child care, rather than treating coercive population measures as effective or constitutionally unproblematic.

Common error: equating population size with unemployment, poverty or environmental damage without examining productivity, consumption patterns and institutions. A smaller but very resource-intensive population can impose heavy ecological costs; well-designed services can improve outcomes even in densely settled areas. The appropriate framework is rights-based demographic planning using dated Census, NFHS and registration data.

16. Agrarian distress: beyond one drought or crop failure

Agrarian distress is sustained instability in farming livelihoods, debt and productive assets, not a synonym for a bad harvest. Risks arise from rainfall variability, pests, price volatility, input costs, fragmented holdings, tenancy, weak storage, market concentration, credit terms and uncertain compensation. **Production risk** concerns yield; **market risk** concerns price or sale conditions; **institutional risk** concerns contracts, eligibility, data quality and delayed payments. Farmers growing different crops face different risks and should not be portrayed as identical.

The **Cobweb model** helps explain how price expectations can produce cycles in agricultural supply, though real markets are more complex. **Terms of trade** between farm output and inputs matter because higher gross receipts may coexist with falling net margins. Cost concepts matter: gross revenue, paid-out costs, imputed family labour, rent and capital costs yield different profitability measures. Debt itself is not always evidence of distress; distress arises when repayment obligations exceed credible earning capacity or require harmful coping such as asset sales and school withdrawal.

Telangana cases can compare cotton price/pest exposure and paddy's water-energy demands. Tank and groundwater management affects income stability; crop procurement and market integration affect price realisation. Policy requires risk-appropriate insurance, transparent crop-loss assessment, non-exploitative credit, farmer producer organisations, timely settlement, extension services and diversification supported by real buyers. Social protection must reach **tenant cultivators and agricultural labourers**, not only titled landowners. Use suicides data with care: recorded incidence does not establish one universal cause and deserves humane, non-sensational interpretation.

17. Migration: circulatory livelihoods and unequal urban citizenship

Migration is movement involving a change of usual residence or work location, and can be **intra-district, inter-district, interstate, international, seasonal, circular, temporary or permanent**. Seasonal workers may maintain rural household membership while working for part of the year in a city; a one-time census can miss the full circulation of labour. Push–pull explanations identify drought, wages, education and jobs, but migration networks, contractors, discrimination, policy and family strategies are equally important. Distinguish **distress migration** from an informed move that genuinely expands capabilities; migrants can experience both opportunity and insecurity.

In Telangana, Hyderabad attracts construction, service, education and knowledge-sector migration, while some households in dryland or tribal areas engage in seasonal work. The same household may depend on village farming, city wages and remittances. Informal tenants and circular migrants face barriers to school admission, healthcare continuity, voter registration, portable benefits and safe accommodation. Labour contractors can help match jobs while also increasing dependence when conditions are opaque.

Policy must build portable food and health entitlements, accessible documentation, language-sensitive schools, registration of workers without discrimination, safe hostel/rental accommodation and effective wage complaints. The **One Nation One Ration Card** portability architecture is relevant for eligible beneficiaries, but entitlement portability does not itself supply adequate housing or fair wages. Evaluate migrants by wage retention, access to care, children’s school continuity, workplace injuries, remittance security and ability to make informed choices. **Nuance:** the aim is not to stop all migration; it is to remove coercive conditions and protect mobility as a route to opportunity.

18. Cross-topic synthesis: how social problems reinforce one another

Social issues form a causal network rather than a catalogue. A failed monsoon can reduce farm earnings; debt can prompt circular migration; insecure urban accommodation can interrupt school; child work can reduce future skills; low wages and poor health can prolong poverty. Caste exclusion and gendered care duties make shocks more severe for some households. Conversely, a public-service improvement can influence several outcomes: reliable childcare may increase women's paid employment, improve child nutrition and reduce unsafe care arrangements. A watershed project that raises water reliability may reduce seasonal job loss but still exclude tenant farmers if land titles are the sole eligibility criterion.

Diagnostic chain for mains: Identify the initiating shock → exposure and structural inequality → household coping → institutional response → unintended consequence → measurable recovery. For Telangana, a useful two-location comparison is a drought-exposed rural settlement and a peripheral Hyderabad migrant neighbourhood. Avoid presenting either as a single uniform type; different families face different rights, assets and mobility options. Include the constitutional commitment to dignity and equality, and one practicable interdepartmental recommendation.

19. Examination-ready distinctions and comparative anchors

Confused pair	Correct distinction	Why it matters
Monetary poverty / MPI	Command over income or consumption / multiple weighted deprivations	Trend conclusions depend on measure and survey year
Unemployment / underemployment	Not employed under survey definition / inadequate hours or productivity	Job quantity and job quality differ
PLFS UR / LFPR	Unemployed divided by labour force / labour force divided by population	Different denominators; never substitute
Child work / prohibited child labour	Appropriate activity may exist / law restricts child employment and hazardous adolescent work	Legal exceptions are limited and contested
Reported crime / prevalence	Registered cases / underlying actual incidence	Greater reporting may change registered counts
Regional identity / exclusionary regionalism	Constitutional assertion / denial of others' equal rights	Regionalism is not uniformly anti-national
Secularism / irreligion	State constitutional relation to religion / absence of belief	Religious freedom is protected
Farmer / agricultural labourer	Operator who undertakes production risk / person selling farm labour	Policies must target correct beneficiary
Urban growth / urbanisation	More urban residents / rising urban share and/or reclassification	Data categories and boundaries affect trends
Relocation / rehabilitation	Change of residence / restoration of livelihoods and social networks	Compensation alone is incomplete
Adaptation / mitigation	Reduce climate damage / reduce causes of climate change	Interventions and metrics differ
TFR / population momentum	Period fertility measure / growth from age structure	Declining fertility need not stop immediate growth
Circular / permanent migration	Repeated moves retaining origin link / durable relocation	Welfare portability priorities differ

20. Recommended reading pathways, without page-number citations in the student chapter

Read NCERT Class XII *Indian Society* and *Social Change and Development in India* for concepts; Amartya Sen's *Development as Freedom* for capabilities; Jean Drèze and Amartya Sen's *An Uncertain Glory* for public-service and development reasoning; selected Indian sociology textbooks for caste, rural change and urbanisation; MoSPI PLFS methodology for labour denominators; NITI Aayog's MPI report for poverty measurement; Telangana Socio-Economic

Outlook 2026 for dated state context; and the text of the child-labour, domestic-violence, labour-guarantee and land-acquisition laws for exact legal provisions. Treat textbooks as conceptual foundations, not as substitutes for up-to-date official data or operative statutes.

SECTION 05 / PAPER III

Concept maps and comparative tables

Visual learning and analytical diagrams

Social-issue feedback loop

```
Erratic income / exclusion / ecological shock
               |
               v
         household debt
               |
        +------+-------+
        |              |
        v              v
  child work       circular migration
        |              |
        v              v
school disruption   insecure urban housing
        |              |
        +------+-------+
               v
      lower capabilities
               |
               v
        persistent poverty
```

Policy logic hierarchy

```
Diagnosis → Causal mechanism → Legal entitlement → Service delivery
   → Accessible remedy → Outcome indicator → Independent audit
```

Population transition versus labour outcome

```
Fertility declines → Working-age share may rise
                   → Jobs and women's work needed
                   → Potential demographic dividend
                   → Otherwise prolonged precarity
```

Displacement accountability chain

```
Project alternatives → Impact identification → SIA/hearing where required
→ Titleholders + tenants + common-resource users recognised
→ Replacement livelihoods, services, housing → multi-year monitoring
```

Telangana case-link grid

Setting	Mechanism	Appropriate metric
Dryland farming area	Weather + price shocks, credit	Real net farm income and debt-service burden
Rural labour market	Seasonal wage demand	Workdays, real wages, tail-end entitlements
Migrant urban settlement	Insecure tenure and service discontinuity	School continuity, rent/income, water access
Hyderabad western employment corridor	Matching, mobility, care work	Commute time, worker retention, women's participation
Musi catchment	Impervious land + drainage + pollution	Exposure, flood incidence and water quality
Reservoir-affected village	Economic displacement	Restored livelihood at year 1, 3 and 5

SECTION 06 / PAPER III

Dated current developments

Topic-linked current developments (dated and carefully qualified)

1. Telangana Socio-Economic Outlook 2026

The Telangana State Portal lists a **2026 Socio-Economic Outlook** in its annual reports catalogue. It can be used for updated sector, labour, social development, urbanisation and farming context. **Do not insert unverifiable district rates from memory**; the detailed report's measure and year must be checked before using a number. This is an official source, not proof that every desired indicator was measured in 2026.

2. Periodic Labour Force Survey: 2025 annual and 2026 monthly publications

MoSPI published the **Annual PLFS 2025 report in 2026** and monthly CWS tables for the 2026 reference period. The September 2026 MoSPI dashboard reports the all-India **CWS unemployment rate for persons aged 15+ as 5.0%**. This is **not** the Telangana rate, not a 2025 annual usual-status estimate, and not a youth-specific rate. These definitions matter in mains answers on educated unemployment and labour-market distress.

3. Poverty indicator and dated projection

NITI Aayog's **15 January 2024** discussion paper estimated India's multidimensional poverty headcount at **11.28% for 2022–23**. Its projected nature and the MPI's weighting are essential qualifying facts. There is no basis to present this as a direct enumeration of 2026 income poverty or as a complete explanation of inequality.

4. Child labour and rights-based governance

The Labour Ministry's official text of the **Child and Adolescent Labour Act**, reflecting the **2016 amendment**, is the controlling examination reference for general prohibitions and limited exemptions. It should be read with the RTE framework, rather than assuming educational enrollment automatically establishes a child's safety.

5. Development and displacement law

The official text of the **2013 land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement law** details objections, hearings and resettlement procedures for covered acquisitions. The exact regime and applicable state changes must be checked for a real project; the presence of an Act is not proof of successful rehabilitation.

SECTION 07 / PAPER III

Mains answer blueprints

Mains answer blueprints: how to score through unique arguments

Each blueprint is tied to its specific question in the separate answer bank. Do not interchange these structures mechanically.

Practice question	Introduction	High-value body components	Distinctive conclusion
Q1 Poverty and money	Differentiate monetary and capability deprivation	MPI dimensions and reference year; chronic/transient; Telangana rural and rental cases; measurement limitation	Judge outcomes through both income and service security
Q2 Falling UR	State labour-force denominator	PLFS usual vs CWS; LFPR/WPR; underemployment; job quality and Hyderabad skill mismatch	A job-quality dashboard is more useful than one rate
Q3 Child labour	Rights and intergenerational cycle	2016 law's exceptions; adult income; home work; RTE and migrant school continuity	Sustained schooling + adult earnings, not rescue totals
Q4 Violence against women	Power and continuum of abuse	PWDVA/POSH distinction; economic dependency; reporting bias; survivor services	Measure usable protection and agency
Q5 Regionalism	Constitutional expression vs exclusion	1956/1969/2014 Telangana sequence; water/jobs and dignity; new within-state gaps	Cooperative federalism with fair resident rights
Q6 Displacement	Physical vs economic loss	Cernea; non-titleholders; 2013 law's covered processes; livelihood audit	Capability restoration is the success metric
Q7 Agrarian distress	Multi-risk livelihood system	Rainfall, price, credit, wages, tenancy; circular migration; MGNREGA household unit	Farm viability + labour dignity + safe mobility
Q8 Hyderabad	Agglomeration with unequal costs	Historic urban layers; ORR; Metro first/ last mile; Musi; GHMC vs HMDA	Ecological coordination + affordable access

Presentation technique: Use a concrete thesis in the opening, 3–4 separate cause-and-effect paragraphs, one named institution or statute, one Telangana case and one testable implication. Avoid a long list of schemes disconnected from the question.

SECTION 08 / PAPER III

Eight complete mains model answers

Professional Mains Answer Bank — Social Issues

Eight original practice prompts; none is presented as an official previous-year TGPSC question. The formal Paper-III pattern suggests answers of approximately 200 words for a 10-mark question. Each answer below prioritises a focused thesis, differentiated evidence, a Telangana illustration where useful, a limitation and an actionable conclusion.

Question 1. Poverty reduction cannot be assessed through income alone. Critically discuss.

Thesis and definition. Monetary poverty indicates shortfall against an income or consumption threshold, but deprivation also operates through health, schooling, sanitation, secure work and decision-making power. A household may cross a monetary line while remaining vulnerable to one illness or crop loss.

Distinct analytical points. First, the multidimensional-poverty framework captures weighted deprivations across health, education and living standards; it is conceptually different from measuring consumption poverty. Second, *transient poverty* may result from an accident, poor monsoon or job loss, whereas chronic poverty involves persistent constraints on assets and capabilities. Third, social exclusion prevents equal conversion of resources into opportunities: insecure tenants or socially disadvantaged communities may receive fewer benefits from similar income. Fourth, unpaid care, transport cost and debt mean household income conceals unequal individual access.

Evidence and Telangana application. NITI Aayog estimated India's multidimensional-poverty headcount at 11.28% for 2022–23, based on its specified estimation method; this must not be described as a 2026 monetary-poverty survey. Telangana's dryland farm families and Hyderabad's low-income renters face different vulnerability mechanisms.

Evaluation and conclusion. Policy should combine employment security, reliable primary services, health-risk protection and secure housing. Progress should be assessed through both monetary outcomes and multidimensional indicators, with clear reference periods and denominators. Poverty alleviation is durable when **capabilities and resilience**, not merely transfers, improve.

Question 2. Why can a falling unemployment rate coexist with persistent labour-market distress?

Introduction. A lower unemployment rate signals a specific improvement only when its *survey definition, population and reference period* are clear. It does not automatically establish adequate income or job quality.

Analytical body. Open unemployment is different from time-related underemployment, informal work or low-productivity family labour. PLFS usual-status estimates and current-weekly-status estimates use different time frames; the unemployment rate is calculated using the labour force as denominator, while LFPR and WPR use the population. A person taking poorly paid occasional work may be classified as employed even while seeking more hours. Women's entry into low-paid own-account work can raise participation without guaranteeing financial autonomy. Educated youth may remain unemployed when qualification, employer demand, location and hiring networks do not match. Hyderabad's IT and pharma employers need specialised capabilities, while rural graduates face mobility and training costs; informal service jobs can be accessible but insecure.

Institutional response. Labour-intensive manufacturing and urban services create demand; apprenticeships and local placement improve matching; childcare and safe mobility expand women's work choices; portable social insurance helps mobile workers. Rural employment guarantees are useful buffers but should not be mistaken for high-productivity permanent jobs.

Conclusion. Assess employment with **hours, real earnings, stability, safety, productivity and women's bargaining power** in addition to a properly dated UR. The test is not whether everyone recorded some work, but whether work secures dignified, sustainable livelihoods.

Question 3. Child labour reflects both household vulnerability and demand for cheap informal work. Analyse.

Introduction. Child labour is not caused by household poverty alone; insecure adult earnings interact with demand for inexpensive, difficult-to-monitor labour in subcontracted production and informal services.

Causes. When illness or debt reduces adult income, children may be withdrawn from school to earn money or provide unpaid household care. Lost learning and early occupational exposure then weaken adult earning capacity, reproducing deprivation. Informal workshops and home-based units may conceal commercial labour inside family settings, while migrant households face gaps in school continuity and documentation. Girls' domestic tasks are particularly undercounted. The Child and Adolescent Labour Act, amended in **2016**, generally prohibits employment of children under 14, permits legally constrained exceptions, and prohibits adolescents aged 14–18 from specified hazardous work. Its family-work exception is debated; the law is not a blanket permission for child employment.

Telangana application. For an urban migrant household, safe access to nearby schools, language support and stable adult wages may be as important as inspections. Rural seasonal migration demands admission flexibility and learning-recovery systems.

Way forward. Combine labour inspection with adult wage security, RTE-based schooling for ages 6–14, cash/food support for vulnerable households and rehabilitation of rescued children. Monitor **sustained attendance and learning**, not merely rescue counts.

Conclusion. Child labour prevention is a joined-up employment, education and child-protection obligation, not a one-department policing exercise.

Question 4. Examine the structural causes of violence against women and the limits of law-only approaches.

Introduction. Violence against women is sustained by unequal power and social norms as well as failures of public institutions. It spans physical, sexual, psychological and economic abuse, including digital harassment.

Explanation. Economic dependence can make separation from an abusive environment difficult. Shame and threats can reduce reporting; poor access to shelters and legal aid can prolong danger. Workplace hierarchies and precarious contracts obstruct complaints, especially for domestic, service and informal workers. The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, **2005**, supplies a protection framework including non-physical harms. The POSH Act, **2013**, deals with workplace harassment and institutional redressal. Neither statute eliminates risks merely by existing. Registered offences measure reporting as well as incidence; rising case counts cannot be interpreted without context.

Telangana illustration. Hyderabad's growing commuter, platform and professional work environments demand functioning workplace committees, safe last-mile transport, digital reporting options and protection against retaliation. Such settings should be analysed without alleging unverified crimes at particular institutions.

Response. Effective policy requires rapid healthcare, trauma-informed evidence collection, credible policing, legal aid, independent workplace processes, economic options and prevention in schools and communities. Measure response time, protection compliance, repeat harm and survivor access to remedies.

Conclusion. Equality demands a shift from **formal protective provisions to usable safety, voice and economic autonomy**. Survivor-centred implementation is the true measure of policy effectiveness.

Question 5. Is regionalism a threat to national integration? Answer with reference to Telangana.

Thesis. Regionalism can either improve democratic representation or undermine equal citizenship; its character depends on the demands, methods and institutional response.

Arguments. Unequal distribution of jobs, irrigation, education and expenditure may create legitimate territorial grievances. Linguistic and cultural recognition also matters because citizenship includes voice and dignity. Telangana's trajectory—from the **1956 Gentlemen's Agreement**, through the **1969 agitation**, subsequent mobilisation and the **Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014**—illustrates the constitutional accommodation of regional demands. Formation on **2 June 2014** was a political-institutional response, not a guarantee that economic disparities disappeared. Hyderabad's concentration of investment and services presents a continuing internal regional-balancing challenge.

Critical distinction. A movement for transparent safeguards or new statehood is not inherently anti-national. Regionalism becomes exclusionary when it denies other citizens freedom of movement, equal law enforcement or livelihood opportunities. Administrative boundaries cannot replace evidence-led distribution of public resources.

Way forward. Strengthen state and local fiscal accountability, publish district-level outcomes, create fair recruitment systems, cooperate on shared water resources and develop secondary urban centres. Evaluate not only allocations but timely execution and service access.

Conclusion. Well-governed federalism transforms regional claims into negotiation and accountability. National integration is strongest when regional dignity and **constitutional equality for every resident** advance together.

Question 6. Development-induced displacement reveals a gap between project benefits and social costs. Examine.

Introduction. Infrastructure and resource development may generate widespread benefits while imposing concentrated losses on families whose homes, land, work or common resources are affected.

Conceptual distinction. Physical displacement is relocation of residence; economic displacement may arise from lost farms, grazing, fishing, market access or informal businesses even without relocation. Michael Cernea's impoverishment-risks model identifies landlessness, joblessness, homelessness, marginalisation, food insecurity, morbidity, common-resource loss and social disarticulation. A one-time land cheque cannot automatically restore these networks.

Legal framework. The **2013 land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement statute** introduced procedures including social-impact assessment and rehabilitation/resettlement in cases it governs. Project-specific regimes, applicable amendments and exceptions must be separately checked. An entitlement list built only around registered owners may overlook tenants, sharecroppers and informal wage earners.

Telangana application. Large irrigation and metropolitan transport projects should be examined through transparent affected-household surveys, village services, livelihood opportunities and the fate of common resources; avoid invented project displacement totals.

Reform agenda. Identify all categories of affected people before approval, disclose alternatives, provide grievance hearings, guarantee replacement housing and basic services, protect cultural sites, and monitor livelihoods for years after resettlement.

Conclusion. A development project is genuinely inclusive when **the people bearing its costs can recover their capabilities**, rather than merely receiving nominal compensation.

Question 7. Examine the interconnected nature of agrarian distress, agricultural labour insecurity and migration.

Introduction. Agrarian distress is a livelihood-system problem. Crop failure is one trigger, but unstable prices, rising input costs, fragmented holdings, tenancy and credit terms may also erode net farm income.

Causal chain. Rainfall uncertainty and pest damage lower yield, while market swings can reduce prices even after a good harvest. Debt becomes distressing when repayments exceed feasible earnings. Farm labourers face seasonal demand, low bargaining power and exposure to heat and chemicals; their conditions may worsen even if crop output rises. When local work disappears, households may send members to construction or services in Hyderabad or elsewhere, retaining a circular link with the village. Migration can diversify earnings but also exposes workers to contractor dependence, insecure housing and children's interrupted schooling.

Distinct Telangana examples. Cotton-growing areas face production and market uncertainties, while paddy cultivation raises irrigation and energy questions. Migrant construction settlements near expanding urban corridors may need portable food entitlements, wage redressal and school continuity.

Policy package. Integrate protective irrigation, transparent procurement, timely crop insurance, tenant-sensitive credit, quality local nonfarm jobs, wage enforcement and MGNREGA's rural **household** employment guarantee. Measure real net farm income, days of paid labour, indebtedness, migrant wage retention and children's attendance.

Conclusion. The solution is not to prevent mobility, but to make **farming viable, farm labour dignified and migration a choice rather than desperation**.

Question 8. Sustainable urbanisation requires environmental justice and metropolitan coordination. Discuss with Hyderabad.

Opening. Cities generate jobs and productivity through agglomeration, but unplanned expansion can place environmental and housing costs disproportionately on low-income residents.

Hyderabad's spatial evidence. The older city around Charminar, Secunderabad, industrial corridors and western IT clusters grew through different political and economic phases. ORR enhances orbital connectivity but can encourage peri-urban conversion. Metro rail improves movement on selected corridors, but accessibility depends on safe walking, bus feeders, transfers and fares. The **Musi basin** connects urban sewage, lake systems, impervious surfaces and flood risk; one jurisdiction cannot manage the catchment in isolation.

Institutional dimension. GHMC has municipal service functions while **HMDA** works across a wider metropolitan-planning area. Published Master Planning **2031** materials are planning instruments, not proof that all proposed infrastructure has been built. Informal tenants, migrant households and workers at exposed outdoor sites need recognition in service data and heat/flood preparedness.

Way forward. Join land-use rules, catchment restoration, wastewater treatment, affordable rental housing, inclusive transit and transparent development permissions. Track neighbourhood air and water quality, commute time, flood exposure and rent burdens, not just kilometres of road or Metro.

Conclusion. A sustainable metropolis is not simply larger or richer; it **coordinates growth with ecological limits and equal access to essential urban capabilities**.

Model-answer self-audit

A high-scoring answer should contain: (i) an issue-specific definition, (ii) at least three distinct causes or mechanisms, (iii) a named legal or analytical concept, (iv) an accurate Telangana case where relevant, (v) one counterargument or limitation, and (vi) a practicable evaluative conclusion. Avoid generic paragraphs repeated across unrelated questions.

SECTION 09 / PAPER III

Fifteen explained original MCQs

Original practice questions — explained MCQs (not official PYQs)

1. Which is a correct interpretation of India's multidimensional poverty index?

A. It measures only whether income is below a monetary poverty line.
B. It combines deprivations in health, education and living standards.
C. It is identical to the unemployment rate.
D. It measures only consumption of food grains.

Answer: B. MPI combines weighted deprivations; it should not be substituted for monetary-poverty estimates. The NITI Aayog 2022–23 figure is an estimate, not a direct 2026 enumeration.

2. Which ratio uses the labour force, not the entire population, as denominator?

A. WPR B. LFPR C. UR D. Literacy rate

Answer: C. UR = unemployed / labour force. LFPR = labour force / population; WPR = workers / population. All require a stated age band and survey convention.

3. The distinction between usual-status and current-weekly-status PLFS measures matters because they:

A. use the same activity reference period.
B. apply to different countries only.
C. classify activity using different reference periods.
D. measure only job satisfaction.

Answer: C. A current-weekly measure cannot be casually compared against a longer usual-status measure; this can change the employment classification.

4. Under the Child and Adolescent Labour law amended in 2016, which assertion is most accurate?

A. Every adolescent aged 14–18 may work in hazardous mines.
B. Child employment is generally prohibited, with legally specified limited exceptions, and adolescent hazardous work is prohibited.
C. All school attendance guarantees eliminate child labour.
D. The law defines adolescents as persons aged 18–21.

Answer: B. The statute includes a general child-employment prohibition with limited exceptions; adolescent hazardous occupations are specifically restricted. Age, work category and statutory exceptions must be checked.

5. The 2005 law providing civil protection from domestic abuse is distinct from:

A. the 2013 POSH statute on workplace harassment.
B. Articles 14–16.
C. the legal aid system.
D. housing support.

Answer: A. PWDVA provides domestic-protection remedies; POSH creates workplace prevention and redressal obligations. They address different institutional settings.

6. Which date is correctly associated with the establishment of the Telangana state?

A. 1 November 1956 B. 2 June 2014 C. 15 August 1947 D. 1 May 1960

Answer: B. Telangana's state formation took effect on 2 June 2014 under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act 2014. The 1956 arrangements concern an earlier reorganisation episode.

7. Which is NOT necessarily communalism?

A. Political mobilisation claiming communities have irreconcilable interests.
B. Spreading hatred between religious groups.
C. Peaceful observance of one's religious practices within constitutional limits.
D. Exclusionary stereotyping of another religious group.

Answer: C. Religious observance is not itself communalism; communalism is antagonistic political construction of religious community interests.

8. Which is the most helpful way to evaluate an anti-corruption e-governance initiative?

A. Count websites created.
B. Count computer terminals bought.
C. Track citizen service time, appeal access, audit findings and unjustified discretion.
D. Assume corruption ended after digitisation.

Answer: C. Digital interfaces may reduce contact points but can create fresh opacity or exclusion. Outcome indicators and appeals are essential.

9. M.N. Srinivas's idea of a dominant caste highlights:

A. ritual rank as the only dimension of caste power.
B. the interaction of numbers, land and political influence.
C. the absence of local conflict.
D. that caste determines occupation without change.

Answer: B. Dominance can arise through land, numbers, education and political power, not simply ritual prestige.

10. MGNREGA's basic statutory guarantee is best stated as:

A. 100 days for every individual citizen.
B. 100 days of wage employment each financial year to each eligible rural household whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work.
C. a permanent urban civil-service job.
D. a subsidy exclusively for land-owning farmers.

Answer: B. Its statutory unit is a rural household, not each individual; this distinction is often missed in mains writing.

11. Economic displacement can occur when a household:

A. moves home and retains every productive asset.
B. loses access to grazing, fishing or wage opportunities without changing its residence.
C. receives a school certificate.
D. experiences a temporary rain shower.

Answer: B. Compensation for land titles may fail to restore common-resource dependence and income networks.

12. A decline in TFR need not immediately stop population growth due to:

A. demographic momentum from age structure.
B. a mathematical necessity that deaths become zero.
C. the disappearance of migration.
D. changes in currency circulation.

Answer: A. A large population entering reproductive ages can sustain births while fertility per woman falls.

13. Which is the most defensible view of migration?

A. All migration must be prevented.
B. Every migrant automatically escapes poverty.
C. Migration can widen opportunity or reproduce vulnerability depending on rights, earnings, housing and service portability.
D. Circular migrants do not require access to schools.

Answer: C. Distinguish chosen opportunity-seeking moves from distress and contractor dependence.

14. The strongest indicator of sustainable urban transport is:

A. kilometres of Metro track alone.
B. total private vehicle sales.
C. affordable, safe door-to-door access incorporating walkability and feeder services.
D. number of flyovers announced.

Answer: C. Transport equity depends on actual accessibility, not exclusively high-profile construction totals.

15. Why is rehabilitation broader than compensation?

A. Rehabilitation counts only property prices.
B. Rehabilitation includes livelihood recovery, services, networks and common resources.
C. Rehabilitation need not identify affected households.
D. Rehabilitation necessarily ends when a cheque is issued.

Answer: B. Cernea's framework highlights multiple impoverishment risks beyond titleholder land value.

Additional mains prompts for self-practice

1. Compare poverty and social exclusion and identify a cause-and-effect interaction.
2. Critically analyse women's employment in informal labour markets using PLFS concepts.
3. Can social protection reduce distress migration without restricting voluntary mobility?
4. Analyse a Musi catchment intervention through environmental justice.
5. Explain when regional assertion strengthens constitutional federalism.
6. Examine the social risks of large infrastructure projects and appropriate safeguards.

SECTION 10 / PAPER III

Authenticated TGPSC mains PYQs status

Verified TGPSC mains PYQs

No official previous-year question has been independently authenticated for this numbered chapter. The eight model questions in `complete-model-answers.md` are newly written practice and are not represented as official TGPSC past questions. Add year, paper, question number, exact wording and commission source only after checking the original.

SECTION 11 / PAPER III

Authenticated TGPSC MCQ PYQs status

Verified official multiple-choice PYQs

No officially authenticated TGPSC MCQ PYQs are provided for this topic. The original explained practice questions below are separate and must not be relabelled as previous-year questions.